you need to bypass the usual conneg mechanisms for specific action methods, and there are various ways to achieve this, but I won't cover them in this book as I've found I rarely need to use them. For details, see Microsoft's "Format response data in ASP.NET Core Web API" documentation: http://mng.bz/zx11.

At this point we've covered the main points of using API controllers, but you probably still have one major question: why would I use web API controllers over minimal APIs? That's a great question, and one we'll look at in section 20.6.

20.6 Choosing between web API controllers and minimal APIs

In part 1 of this book you learned all about using minimal APIs to build a JSON API. Minimal APIs are the new kid on the block, being introduced in .NET 6, but they are growing up quickly. With all the new features introduced in .NET 7 (discussed in chapter 5), minimal APIs are emerging as a great way to build HTTP APIs in modern .NET.

By contrast, web API controllers have been around since day one. They were introduced in their current form in ASP.NET Core 1.0 and were heavily inspired by the web API framework from legacy ASP.NET. The designs, patterns, and concepts used by web API controllers haven't changed much since then, so if you've ever used web API controllers, they should look familiar in .NET 7.

The difficult question in .NET 7 is if you need to build an API, which should you use, minimal APIs or web API controllers? Both have their pros and